MD IKRAM HOSSAIN BHUIYAN

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Public Policy; Social Policy, Policy Reform, how institutions and the political environment shape policymaking, Human Rights, Migration, Refugees, Nonprofits

EDUCATION

Master's in Political Science (May 2026 - Expected)
Illinois State University, IL, USA

- CGPA: 4.00/4.00
- Thesis Title: "*Program Design as Predictor of Volunteer Intention: A Regression Analysis for Scaling Evidence-Based Volunteer Recruitment*"
- Advisor: Dr. Mike Hendricks

Master's in Governance and Development Studies 2022
Jahangirnagar University, Bangladesh

- CGPA: 3.83/4.00
- Dissertation Title: *"A Quantitative Analysis of the Role of Community Radios in Raising Health Awareness in the Southernmost Area of Bangladesh"*
- Advisor: Dr. Mohammad Tarikul Islam

Bachelor of Arts, Persian Language and Literature 2017
University of Dhaka, Bangladesh

- CGPA: 3.38/4.00

AWARDS & HONORS

- COUNTRY Financial Scholar, ISU (Competitive) (2025)
- ISU Political Science Scholar Award (Competitive) (2025)
- Outstanding External Exposure Award by BRAC (2023)
- Best Training and Motivation Officer Award-2021 by UNICEF (2021)
- Best Performer of the Year-2019 by BacBon Limited (2020)
- Undergrad Merit Award, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh (2017)

PUBLICATIONS

- Imtiaz, N., Zannat, F., Islam Tohfa, R., Mahmud, S., Bhuiyan, M.I.H., et al. (2025). Adaptive learning analytics for optimizing workforce upskilling in U.S. community colleges. Journal of Modern Education and Computer Science Press (under review).

CONFERENCE PAPERS

- Bhuiyan, M.I.H., & Islam, M. T. (2022, September). *A Quantitative Analysis of the Role of Community Radios in Spreading Political Rhetoric in the Southernmost Area of Bangladesh*. 37th "JU Annual Conference on Law and Governance".

PRESENTATIONS

- "The Impact of the Wave of Digital Bangladesh as a Political Agenda" University Research Symposium, Illinois State University, IL, USA 2025
- Community Scorecard of the Marginalized Group in Bangladesh, Bangladesh Bureau of Statistics, Ministry of Information 2024
- Citizen-Generated Data; Empowering the Local Voice, Prime Minister's Office, The People's Republic of Bangladesh 2024
- The Power of Information in Refugee Camps, Inter-Sector Coordination Annual Meeting, Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh 2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Assistant Researcher (Volunteer), Academic Project, ISU (Jul 2025- Present)

- Assisting in a series of surveys on the research project titled "Expanding Access to Urban Nature: Floating Gardens as Equitable and Inclusive Blue-Green Infrastructure in the Chicago River."
- Contributing to designing questionnaires, collecting data from the Chicago neighborhoods, analyzing data, and composing findings and discussion

Research Assistant, Center for Budget and Policy (**CBP**), Bangladesh (Jan- Dec 2015)

- Worked on research projects like "*The Impact of the Seasonal Fishing Ban on Fishermen*" and "*People's Perspective towards Cyclone Shelters*"
- Also collaborated on designing questionnaires, collecting data of 1500+ respondents, analyzing the data using STATA and R, and composing reports for donors

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Illinois State University, IL, USA (Aug 24-Present)

- Designed and delivered instruction for six courses, interacting with around 450 undergraduate students: creating an engaged, discussion-based learning environment
- Developed assessment rubrics with feedback mechanisms; graded weekly quizzes, essays, and exams; provided consultations addressing academic needs and success
- Collaborated with faculty on curriculum revision and course assessment; analyzed student learning outcomes data to inform instructional improvements

Policy Analyst, (Oct 2022– Jun 2024)
BRAC (Bangladesh Rural Advancement Committee), Bangladesh

- Led policy research synthesizing evidence from grassroots implementation of hundreds of various projects across the country, translating community evidence into policy recommendations for national-level policy stakeholders

- Contributed to drafting 12 policy briefs & research reports
- Represented civil society and think tanks in government consultations; provided evidence-based recommendations informing concerned ministries

Contributed to the following research, features, and national-level reports as part of my responsibilities:

- BRAC SDG Contribution Voluntary Review 2023
- Citizens' Assessment of District Level Social Safety Net Programs, 2023

Communication with Communities (CwC) Coordinator (Dec 20– Sep 22)
UNICEF, Bangladesh

- Contributed to the following research as (CwC):
  - Information Access of Rohingya Refugees in Bangladesh, 2021
  - Radio Listenership Survey in Cox's Bazar, 2021
- Supported in designing and conducting multiple research projects that include administering surveys with 6000 Rohingya refugee respondents
- Reinforced the community engagement through 500+ courtyard sessions, 1000+ Audio & video content, 20+ campaigns, RCCE interventions
- Liaised with different governmental/non-governmental and international stakeholders and produced quantitative and qualitative reports on socio-political circumstances

Project Manager , BacBon Ltd., Bangladesh (Jan 2019– Nov 2020**)**

- Led a project for the government on behalf of BacBon, which is about training secondary school teachers across the country in a new national curriculum
- Conducted 4 surveys with twelve hundred teachers and students, 13 FGDs, and 26 KIIs in 13 districts on subjective skills and ethics
- Organized and conducted 100+ teacher training and capacity-building workshops

Project Officer, e-Education (**NPO**), Tokyo, Japan (Jan 2018- Dec 2018)

- Raised five million USD donation through crowdfunding for Rohingya refugees
- Replicated a distance-learning education program for the marginalized students
- Led a youth leadership program titled LAMP, combining the participation of three (03) countries: Japan, Myanmar, and Bangladesh

Project Intern, BacBon Ltd., Dhaka, Bangladesh (Jan 2016- Dec 2017)

- Assisted in developing Audio-Visual education content for primary students, secondary students, university admission aspirants, and primary teachers, as well
- Conducted 15+ surveys, FGDs, and KIIs in 9 districts on education and social issues

TRAINING & CERTIFICATES

- Certificate on Field Research by World Bank (2024)
- Right to Information (RTI) Act Training Certificate by BRAC (2023)
- Global Diplomacy – Diplomacy in the Modern World (2020)
  Authorized by the University of London and SOAS University
- The Sustainable Development Goals–A global, transdisciplinary vision (2020)
  Authorized by the University of Copenhagen
- Leadership Development & Social Leaders as "Social Change Maker", Japan (2018)
  by Toyota Foundation
- Innovations and Social Constructions as "Social Change Maker", Myanmar (2018)
  by Toyota Foundation

SKILLS

Research Methodology:

- Quantitative | Qualitative | Mix-methods

Language Proficiency:

- **English:** Advanced, **Bengali:** Native, **Persian:** Moderate

Computer/Software:

- **R** (Moderate), **Stata** (Moderate), Microsoft Office Suite (Advanced), Adobe Creative Cloud (Premiere Pro, After Effects), **Arc GIS** (Moderate)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Graduate School Advisory Council, Illinois State University, IL (Aug 2025-Present)
- General Secretary, Bangladesh Student Association, Registered Student Organization, Illinois State University, IL (Nov 2024- Present)
- Active Member, Pi Sigma Alpha (May 2025- Present)
- Member & Alumni, Dhaka University IT Society (Apr 2014 – Present)
- Fund Raiser, Rohingya Refugee Aid, NPO e-Education (Aug 2017- Dec 2017)